# ZAINAB TAHA

*Cybersecurity Student | GRC, Network & Cloud Security, Security Operations*
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## SUMMARY

Senior Cybersecurity student at Effat University (GPA 3.86/4.00) with hands-on project experience in threat detection, adversary emulation, and compliance automation. Built security tools using Python, Docker, Terraform, CI/CD, and map technical controls to MITRE ATT&CK, NIST CSF, ISO 27001, NCA ECC, and PDPL. Seeking a cybersecurity internship starting January 2027.

## EDUCATION

**Effat University** **Jeddah, Saudi Arabia**
*Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Cybersecurity Track | GPA: 3.86 / 4.00* *Expected June 2027*
**President's List (2025/2026)** – academic achievement by maintaining a GPA of 3.9 & higher across two consecutive semesters.
**Dean's List (2024/2025)** – academic achievement by maintaining a GPA of 3.75 & higher across two consecutive semesters.
**Relevant Coursework**: Governance Risk and Compliance, Computer Networks, Ethical Hacking, Cryptography and Network Security, Digital Forensics, Information and Cyber Security, Software Engineering, Artificial Intelligence.

## FEATURED PROJECTS

**Purple-Team Lateral Movement Detection Platform | Senior Capstone** **Jan 2026 - Present**
*Python, Docker, tcpdump, MITRE ATT&CK, NIST CSF, ISO 27001, NCA ECC | github.com/zainabthaa/lateral-movement-showcase*

- Architected a segmented, Docker-based enterprise network of 13 containerized hosts across 3 isolated subnets with an inline IDS sensor bridging the segments to execute and detect lateral-movement attacks end-to-end in a red/blue lab.
- Built an adversary-emulation module generating realistic kill-chain traffic, mapped to 20 MITRE ATT&CK techniques to measure detection coverage.
- Developed a GRC module that maps live detection telemetry to NIST CSF, ISO 27001, and NCA ECC controls, auto-generating control-effectiveness evidence, with access governed by just-in-time and least-privilege controls.
- Engineered a custom real-time IDS pipeline combining behavioral analysis and signature-based rules, feeding the SOC triage dashboard with role-based access, alert assignment, and MTTR tracking computed from live alerts.

**Compliance-as-Code Policy Enforcement Pipeline** **Aug - Sep 2026**
*GitHub Actions, Terraform, OPA/Rego, Conftest, Python, AWS | github.com/zainabthaa/compliance-as-code-pipeline*

- Designed a CI/CD pipeline in GitHub Actions that checks Terraform plans against security controls with OPA/Rego and Conftest, automatically blocking non-compliant pull requests through branch protection.
- Codified 7 CIS AWS Foundations Benchmark controls and 3 custom checks into 6 Rego policy modules covering S3, RDS, security groups, IAM, EBS, and hardcoded secrets.
- Built a Python layer that generates a report and an HTML dashboard on every run, listing failing resources, reason, and the fix.

**NoorPay GRC Engagement: Risk Assessment, Gap Analysis & IR Plan** **Apr - May 2026**
*NIST SP 800-30, NIST SP 800-61, GDPR, Saudi PDPL, CISO Assistant | github.com/zainabthaa/noorpay-grc-assessment*

- Simulated GRC consulting engagement for a Saudi fintech after a breach affecting 12,000 customers; assessed 10 risks (NIST SP 800-30) on a CISO Assistant heat map.
- Audited 12 GDPR/PDPL requirements and wrote a NIST SP 800-61 IR plan with SDAIA/GDPR 72-hour breach notification.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

**GRC & Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST CSF, NIST SP 800-30, ISO 27001, NCA ECC, Saudi PDPL, GDPR, CIS Benchmarks, security policies, risk and control assessment, gap analysis, control mapping
**Networking & Systems:** TCP/IP, network segmentation, Linux, Kali Linux, Wireshark, Nmap, tcpdump
**Security Operations:** SOC monitoring, incident response, intrusion detection, adversary emulation, vulnerability assessment
**Cloud & DevSecOps:** AWS, IAM, Terraform, Docker, GitHub Actions, OPA/Rego, Conftest, CI/CD security
**Programming:** Python, JavaScript, Java, C++, PHP, SQL (MySQL), HTML, Bash | **Languages**: Arabic (Native) and English (Fluent)

## CERTIFICATIONS

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|---|---|
| CompTIA Security+ – In Progress | Expected Jan 2027 |
| Security Operations Center (SOC) Fundamentals – Cisco | May 2026 |
| Introduction to Containers w/ Docker, Kubernetes & OpenShift – IBM | Apr 2026 |
| Introduction to DevOps – IBM | Oct 2025 |

## LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

**Nominee, Student Shura Council President – Effat University** **2026**

- Nominated for Queen Effat Citizenship Award to serve as Student Shura President and student-body representative.

**Vice President, Cyber Security Club – Effat University** **2025-2026**

- Co-founded and co-led planning and execution for 4 hands-on labs, competitions and security workshops.

**Vice President, Society of Petroleum Engineers (SPE) – SPE Chapter, Effat University** **2026-Present**

- Co-founded and co-directed strategic planning and operational execution for technical workshops and community initiatives.